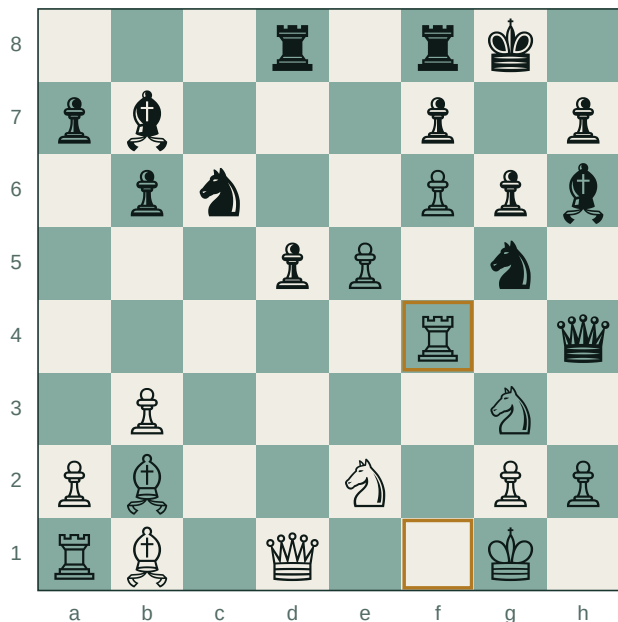


Discovered attacks: Black, move 20

Discovered attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Rf4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Nh3+ 21. gxh3 Bxf4 22. Nxf4 Qxf4

20...Nh3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From h3 it attacks king on g1 and rook on f4. Recorded reply: **21.gxh3**.

21...Bxf4 The bishop captures the rook on f4. Recorded reply: **22.Nxf4**.

22...Qxf4 The queen captures the knight on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +2: the balance goes from +0 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b2 and queen on d1. Check for tactical protection.